

Day 25: Melody writing 1: shape, phrases and answers

Compose · about 40 minutes: warm-up 5 · teach 10 · together 10 · on his own 12 · game 3

1 · WARM-UP (5 MIN)

Today's practice in Philip's corner, or the first two 'together' questions below.

2 · TEACH (10 MIN)

Say: "A good melody is like a good story: a question, an answer, a high point, and a satisfying ending."

- Exam question 3: continue a given opening to make a melody of about 8 bars for an instrument (you choose from a few), with performance directions.
- Structure: two 4-bar phrases. The first ends with an imperfect cadence (or in a new key); the second answers and ends on the tonic.
- Use the opening's rhythm and shape again: repeat it, put it in sequence (the same shape higher or lower), or change it a little.
- Give the melody a high point (climax) about two-thirds of the way through, and end on the tonic on a strong beat.

Worked example

Plan a melody from a 2-bar opening in G major, 4/4.

1. Bars 1-2: the opening. Bars 3-4: answer it, ending on D (imperfect cadence).
2. Bars 5-6: the opening idea in sequence, higher: the climax.
3. Bars 7-8: step down to G, the tonic, on the first beat of bar 8.

Watch out for

- Too many leaps: mostly steps sound more singable.
- Ending on a weak beat or not on the tonic.

In the exam: Question 3 is worth 20 marks: shape, structure, use of the opening and performance directions all count.

Show him these cards

1

Eight bars: two 4-bar phrases.
Phrase 1 ends with an imperfect cadence (or a new key). Phrase 2 answers and ends on the tonic.

2

Reuse the opening's rhythm and shape: repeat it, put it in sequence, or vary it a little.

3

Give the melody a high point about two-thirds of the way through, and end on the tonic on a strong beat.

3 · DO TOGETHER (10 MIN)

- Look at an opening from the Compose game and plan the 8 bars together: where are the cadences, where is the climax?

Four questions to work through together

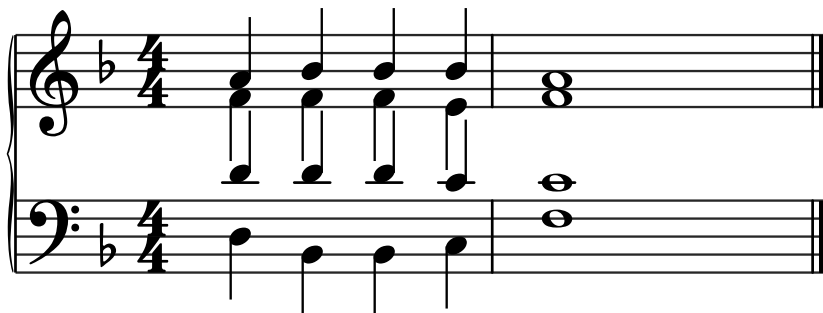
1. What does this mean?

sonoro

A. resonant B. rapid repetition of a note, or quick alternation of two C. release the soft pedal D. sweet notes

Answer: resonant. sonoro is Italian for "resonant".

2. This passage starts in D minor. Which key does it end in?



A. F major B. A minor C. G minor D. D minor

Answer: F major. It ends with a perfect cadence in F major: C-E-G-B $\flat$ then F-A-C. Look for the new accidental: E is the new key's leading note.

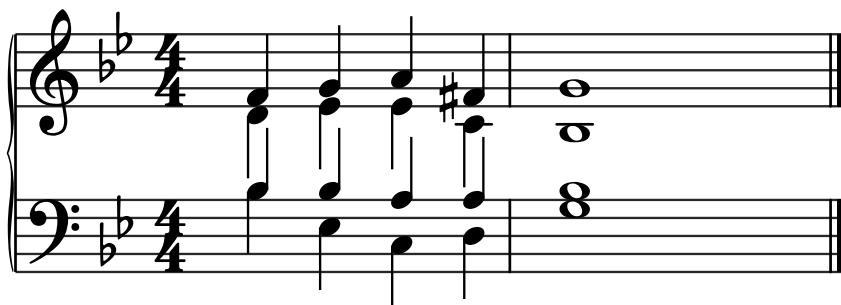
3. What does this mean?

semplice

A. boldly B. but not too much C. simply D. coaxing, charmingly

Answer: simply. semplice is Italian for "simply".

4. This passage starts in B $\flat$ major. Which key does it end in?



A. B $\flat$ major B. F major C. G minor D. E $\flat$ major

Answer: G minor. It ends with a perfect cadence in G minor: D-F $\sharp$ -A-C then G-B $\flat$ -D. Look for the new accidental: F $\sharp$ is the new key's leading note.

TODAY'S COMPOSITION OPENING

Continue this opening for violin to make a melody of 8 bars. It should modulate to the dominant (A major), then return to D major. Add a tempo marking, dynamics, phrasing and other performance

directions.



violin range: G3 upwards (comfortably up to about E6).

Plan it together

1. **Bars 1-2** are given. Notice the rhythm you'll reuse.
2. **Bars 3-4:** answer the opening (try its rhythm again, starting on a different note). End bar 4 on a long note of chord V (A, C#, E): an imperfect cadence.
3. **Bars 5-6:** move to A major. Use G#, its leading note, and end bar 6 on A. Put your high point here.
4. **Bar 7:** cancel G# with G, and head back towards D.
5. **Bar 8:** D, the tonic, on the first beat, as a long note.
6. **Then add:** a tempo word, a dynamic at the start and one change, a crescendo to the high point, slurs over the phrases, and some articulation.

The checklist

1. 8 bars, and every bar adds up to the time signature
2. Two balanced phrases, with a clear cadence at bar 4
3. The opening's rhythm or shape comes back (repeat, sequence or a variation)
4. It modulates clearly (a new accidental, or in a minor key cancelling the raised 7th to reach the relative major) and comes back home
5. A clear high point, and a good shape: mostly steps with some leaps
6. It ends on the tonic, on a strong beat
7. It stays in the instrument's range and suits the instrument
8. A tempo marking (an Italian term is fine)
9. Dynamics, including at least one change
10. Phrasing slurs and some articulation (staccato, accents, tenuto)

MODEL ANSWER (SHOW IT AFTER HE HAS WRITTEN HIS OWN)

Allegretto



1. Bars 3–4 answer the opening and stop on A, the dominant: an imperfect cadence.
2. Bar 5 climbs through C# and E to G#, the leading note of A major; bar 6 lands on A, the high point, on the downbeat: a cadence in the dominant.
3. Bar 7 brings back G#, which takes us home to D major.
4. Bar 8 ends on the tonic, D, on the first beat.
5. Performance directions: a tempo word (*Allegretto*), a quiet start, a crescendo to the high point, slurs over each phrase, and some staccato or accents where they suit the violin.

This is one good answer, not the only one. Compare yours: is the plan the same even if the notes are different?

4 • ON HIS OWN (12 MIN)

- Write a melody from an opening in the Compose game, on paper.

His worksheet is on the next page (answers at the end).

5 • GAME (3 MIN)

Question and answer: you sing a 2-bar question; he sings an answer that ends on the tonic.

MOVE ON WHEN

His melody has two clear phrases, reuses the opening's ideas and ends on the tonic.

Philip's worksheet · Day 25

Name _____ Date _____ Score ____ / 8

1. What does this mean?

stretto

- A. suddenly B. gradually getting quieter C. too much D. getting faster (pressing on)

2. What is the dominant key of C major?

- A. G major B. A $\flat$ major C. C $\sharp$ minor D. B $\flat$ minor

3. Which term means "getting softer and slower"?

- A. en mesure B. sul ponticello C. calando D. larghetto

4. What is the relative minor of C major?

- A. G $\sharp$ minor B. C $\sharp$ minor C. A minor D. D major

5. Which term means "noisily, boisterously"?

- A. cantando B. mässig C. sforzato (sfz) D. strepitoso

6. What is the relative major of D minor?

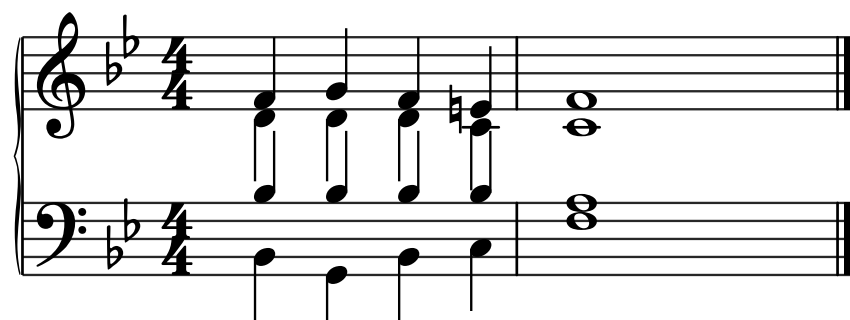
- A. B $\flat$ minor B. B minor C. A major D. F major

7. What does this mean?

en mesure

- A. without a mute B. but C. at choice, freely D. in time

8. This passage starts in B $\flat$ major. Which key does it end in?



- A. F major B. G minor C. E $\flat$ major D. D minor

ANSWERS (FOR MUM)

1. **D: getting faster (pressing on).** stretto is Italian for "getting faster (pressing on)".
2. **A: G major.** The dominant key is built on note 5: G major.
3. **C: calando.** calando is Italian for "getting softer and slower".
4. **C: A minor.** Relative keys share a key signature: C major and A minor.
5. **D: strepitoso.** strepitoso is Italian for "noisily, boisterously".
6. **D: F major.** Relative keys share a key signature: D minor and F major.
7. **D: in time.** en mesure is French for "in time".
8. **A: F major.** It ends with a perfect cadence in F major: C-E-G-B $\flat$ then F-A-C. Look for the new accidental: E is the new key's leading note.

Day 26: Melody writing 2: modulating to a related key

Compose · about 40 minutes: warm-up 5 · teach 10 · together 10 · on his own 12 · game 3

1 · WARM-UP (5 MIN)

Today's practice in Philip's corner, or the first two 'together' questions below.

2 · TEACH (10 MIN)

Say: "A modulation is a short trip. Show the new key clearly, enjoy it, then come home."

- Most exam openings want a modulation, usually to the dominant (or the relative major from a minor key).
- Plan: bars 1-4 in the home key, ending on V or moving to the new key; bars 5-6 in the new key with its new accidental; bars 7-8 back home with a perfect cadence.
- The new key's leading note (F# going from C to G) is what makes a modulation clear.

Worked example

In F major, how do you show a move to C major?

1. C major's leading note is B $\sharp$ (F major has B $\flat$).
2. Use B $\sharp$ rising to C at a cadence in bar 4 or 6.
3. Then bring back B $\flat$ to return to F.

Watch out for

- Modulating without the new accidental.
- Forgetting to come home.

In the exam: The opening often hints at the modulation the examiner expects.

Show him these cards

1

Plan: bars 1-4 in the home key, bars 5-6 in the new key (with its new accidental), bars 7-8 back home with a perfect cadence.

2

From a major key, go to the dominant. From a minor key, go to the relative major (or the dominant minor).

3

The new key's leading note makes the modulation clear: F# when going from C to G.

3 · DO TOGETHER (10 MIN)

- Plan and write a modulating melody together from an opening.

Four questions to work through together

1. What is the relative major of C# minor?

- A. A major B. E major C. G major D. A $\flat$ major

Answer: E major. Relative keys share a key signature: C# minor and E major.

2. Which term means "repeat from the beginning"?

- A. delicato B. da capo (D.C.) C. più D. dolce

Answer: da capo (D.C.). da capo (D.C.) is Italian for "repeat from the beginning".

3. What is the dominant key of C minor?

- A. A major B. B $\flat$ major C. F# minor D. G minor

Answer: G minor. The dominant key is built on note 5: G minor.

4. What does this mean?

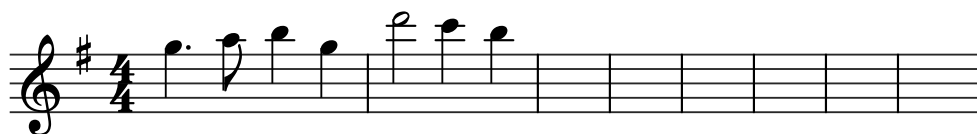
amabile

- A. with spirit B. lovable, pleasant C. not D. restless, worried

Answer: lovable, pleasant. amabile is Italian for "lovable, pleasant".

TODAY'S COMPOSITION OPENING

Continue this opening for flute to make a melody of 8 bars. It should modulate to the dominant (D major), then return to G major. Add a tempo marking, dynamics, phrasing and other performance directions.



flute range: C4 to about C7.

Plan it together

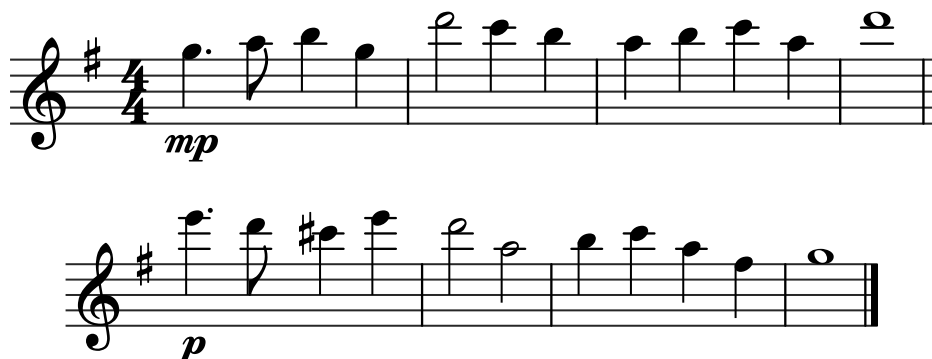
1. **Bars 1-2** are given. Notice the rhythm you'll reuse.
2. **Bars 3-4:** answer the opening (try its rhythm again, starting on a different note). End bar 4 on a long note of chord V (D, F#, A): an imperfect cadence.
3. **Bars 5-6:** move to D major. Use C#, its leading note, and end bar 6 on D. Put your high point here.
4. **Bar 7:** cancel C# with C, and head back towards G.
5. **Bar 8:** G, the tonic, on the first beat, as a long note.
6. **Then add:** a tempo word, a dynamic at the start and one change, a crescendo to the high point, slurs over the phrases, and some articulation.

The checklist

1. 8 bars, and every bar adds up to the time signature
2. Two balanced phrases, with a clear cadence at bar 4
3. The opening's rhythm or shape comes back (repeat, sequence or a variation)
4. It modulates clearly (a new accidental, or in a minor key cancelling the raised 7th to reach the relative major) and comes back home
5. A clear high point, and a good shape: mostly steps with some leaps
6. It ends on the tonic, on a strong beat
7. It stays in the instrument's range and suits the instrument
8. A tempo marking (an Italian term is fine)
9. Dynamics, including at least one change
10. Phrasing slurs and some articulation (staccato, accents, tenuto)

MODEL ANSWER (SHOW IT AFTER HE HAS WRITTEN HIS OWN)

Andante



1. Bars 3–4: a rising answer ending on D, the dominant (imperfect cadence).
2. Bar 5 reuses the opening's dotted rhythm and adds C#: we're in D major, the dominant, cadencing in bar 6.
3. Bar 7 brings back C# and steps down towards home.
4. Bar 8: G, the tonic, held for the whole bar.
5. Performance directions: a tempo word (*Andante*), a quiet start, a crescendo to the high point, slurs over each phrase, and some staccato or accents where they suit the flute.

This is one good answer, not the only one. Compare yours: is the plan the same even if the notes are different?

4 • ON HIS OWN (12 MIN)

- A Compose-game opening that asks for a modulation.

His worksheet is on the next page (answers at the end).

5 • GAME (3 MIN)

Key journey: hum a tune that goes to the dominant and comes back.

MOVE ON WHEN

His melody modulates clearly and comes home.

Philip's worksheet · Day 26

Name _____ Date _____ Score ____ / 8

1. What is the dominant key of E major?

- A. B major B. G major C. E minor D. A $\flat$ major

2. What does this mean?

animé

- A. with energy B. without a mute C. moderately quiet D. animated, lively

3. What is the relative minor of E major?

- A. B minor B. B major C. B $\flat$ major D. C $\sharp$ minor

4. What does this mean?

ritmico

- A. the end B. singing C. held D. rhythmically

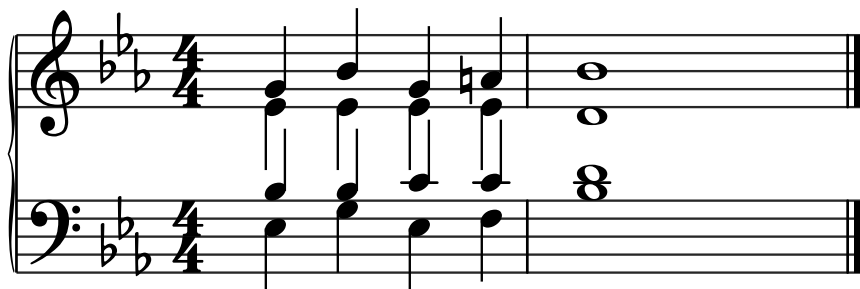
5. What is the dominant key of A major?

- A. C $\sharp$ minor B. G major C. E major D. A minor

6. Which term means "resonant"?

- A. rinforzando (rf, rfz) B. sonoro C. ruhig D. doloroso

7. This passage starts in E $\flat$ major. Which key does it end in?



- A. A $\flat$ major B. B $\flat$ major C. E $\flat$ major D. G minor

8. What does this mean?

pomposo

- A. peaceful B. pressing on, getting quicker C. pompously, grandly D. broadly

ANSWERS (FOR MUM)

1. **A: B major.** The dominant key is built on note 5: B major.
2. **D: animated, lively.** anim   is French for "animated, lively".
3. **D: C   minor.** Relative keys share a key signature: E major and C   minor.
4. **D: rhythmically.** ritmico is Italian for "rhythmically".
5. **C: E major.** The dominant key is built on note 5: E major.
6. **B: sonoro.** sonoro is Italian for "resonant".
7. **B: B   major.** It ends with a perfect cadence in B   major: F-A-C-E   then B  -D-F. Look for the new accidental: A is the new key's leading note.
8. **C: pompously, grandly.** pomposo is Italian for "pompously, grandly".

Day 27: Writing for an instrument: range and performance directions

Compose · about 40 minutes: warm-up 5 · teach 10 · together 10 · on his own 12 · game 3

1 · WARM-UP (5 MIN)

Today's practice in Philip's corner, or the first two 'together' questions below.

2 · TEACH (10 MIN)

Say: "Write for a real person playing a real instrument: keep it in range and tell them how to play it."

- The question names an instrument: write within its range and in its style.
- Violin from G3 (lowest string) upwards; flute from C4; oboe from B $\flat$ 3; clarinet in B $\flat$ is written from E3 (it transposes, so the exam usually avoids it or tells you); cello from C2, in bass clef; trumpet and horn usually avoided.
- Add performance directions: a tempo marking (an Italian term is fine), dynamics including at least one change, phrasing slurs, and some articulation (staccato, accents) where it suits.
- A violin melody can use double stops and bowing marks; wind melodies need places to breathe.

Worked example

Add performance directions to a melody for oboe.

1. A tempo word at the start: Andante.
2. Dynamics: p, then a crescendo to mf at the high point, then dim.
3. Slurs over phrases, a breath mark at bar 4, and staccato on some quavers.

Watch out for

- Notes below the instrument's lowest note.
- No performance directions: easy marks lost.

In the exam: Performance directions are part of the marks in question 3.

Show him these cards

1

Know the instrument: violin from G3 up; flute from C4 up; oboe from B $\flat$ 3; cello from C2 (in bass clef).

2

Add performance directions: a tempo word, dynamics with at least one change, phrasing slurs, and some articulation.

3

Wind players need places to breathe. String players can use bowing and double stops.

3 · DO TOGETHER (10 MIN)

- Write the same opening as a violin melody and a flute melody: what changes?

Four questions to work through together

1. In a full orchestral score, which of these is written higher up the page?

- A. bassoon B. trumpet

Answer: bassoon. Score order from the top: woodwind (flute, oboe, clarinet, bassoon), brass (horn, trumpet, trombone, tuba), percussion (timpani first), then strings (violin I, violin II, viola, cello, double bass). So bassoon comes above trumpet.

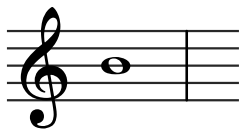
2. What does this mean?

modéré

- A. at a moderate speed B. forced, accented C. quick D. the end

Answer: at a moderate speed. modéré is French for "at a moderate speed".

3. This is the sound you want from the clarinet in B $\flat$. Which note must be written for it?



- A. C $\sharp$ B. C C. B $\sharp$ D. B

Answer: C $\sharp$. The clarinet in B $\flat$ sounds a major 2nd lower than written, so write it UP a major 2nd: B is written as C $\sharp$.

4. What does this mean?

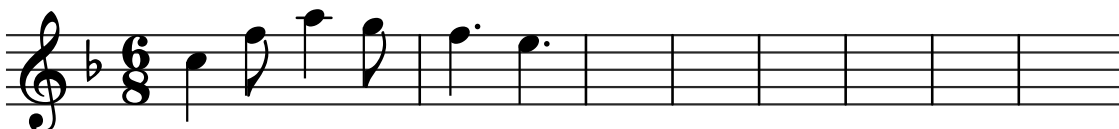
en mesure

- A. in time B. in a singing style C. at a moderate speed D. gradually getting quieter

Answer: in time. en mesure is French for "in time".

TODAY'S COMPOSITION OPENING

Continue this opening for oboe to make a melody of 8 bars. It should modulate to the dominant (C major), then return to F major. Add a tempo marking, dynamics, phrasing and other performance directions.



oboe range: B $\flat$ 3 to about F6.

Plan it together

1. **Bars 1-2** are given. Notice the rhythm you'll reuse.

2. **Bars 3-4:** answer the opening (try its rhythm again, starting on a different note). End bar 4 on a long note of chord V (C, E, G): an imperfect cadence.
3. **Bars 5-6:** move to C major. Use B, its leading note, and end bar 6 on C. Put your high point here.
4. **Bar 7:** cancel B with B $\flat$, and head back towards F.
5. **Bar 8:** F, the tonic, on the first beat, as a long note.
6. **Then add:** a tempo word, a dynamic at the start and one change, a crescendo to the high point, slurs over the phrases, and some articulation.

The checklist

1. 8 bars, and every bar adds up to the time signature
2. Two balanced phrases, with a clear cadence at bar 4
3. The opening's rhythm or shape comes back (repeat, sequence or a variation)
4. It modulates clearly (a new accidental, or in a minor key cancelling the raised 7th to reach the relative major) and comes back home
5. A clear high point, and a good shape: mostly steps with some leaps
6. It ends on the tonic, on a strong beat
7. It stays in the instrument's range and suits the instrument
8. A tempo marking (an Italian term is fine)
9. Dynamics, including at least one change
10. Phrasing slurs and some articulation (staccato, accents, tenuto)

MODEL ANSWER (SHOW IT AFTER HE HAS WRITTEN HIS OWN)

Allegretto



1. Bars 3–4 reuse the opening's rhythm with new notes, then fall to C, the dominant.
2. Bar 5 uses B $\sharp$, the leading note of C major: the music modulates to the dominant, with the high C in bar 6.
3. Bar 7 brings B $\flat$ back: home to F major.
4. Bar 8: F, the tonic, as a dotted minim.
5. Performance directions: a tempo word (*Allegretto*), a quiet start, a crescendo to the high point, slurs over each phrase, and some staccato or accents where they suit the oboe.

This is one good answer, not the only one. Compare yours: is the plan the same even if the notes are different?

4 • ON HIS OWN (12 MIN)

- Orchestra game.

His worksheet is on the next page (answers at the end).

5 • GAME (3 MIN)

Instrument charades: describe a range and sound; he names the instrument.

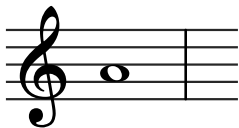
MOVE ON WHEN

His melodies stay in range and include tempo, dynamics, phrasing and articulation.

Philip's worksheet · Day 27

Name _____ Date _____ Score ____ / 8

1. The horn in F plays this written note. Which note actually sounds?



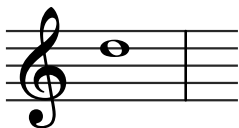
- A. A B. D C. D# D. E

2. What does this mean?

allegro

- A. fast, lively B. swiftly C. two minim beats in a bar D. with force

3. The trumpet in B $\flat$ plays this written note. Which note actually sounds?



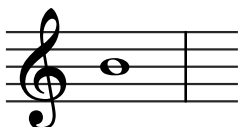
- A. C $\flat$ B. C C. D D. B

4. What does this mean?

tranquillo

- A. dying away in tone and speed B. more C. playful, merry D. calmly

5. The horn in F plays this written note. Which note actually sounds?



- A. B B. E C. D D. E#

6. Which term means "one player alone"?

- A. allegro B. nicht schleppen C. volante D. solo

7. What does 'col legno' mean?

- A. near the bridge B. very smoothly C. with a mute D. with the wood of the bow

8. What does this mean?

sordine

- A. less B. more C. let it ring D. mute

ANSWERS (FOR MUM)

1. **B: D.** The horn in F sounds a perfect 5th lower than written, so go DOWN a perfect 5th: A sounds as D.
2. **A: fast, lively.** allegro is Italian for "fast, lively".
3. **B: C.** The trumpet in B $\flat$ sounds a major 2nd lower than written, so go DOWN a major 2nd: D sounds as C.
4. **D: calmly.** tranquillo is Italian for "calmly".
5. **B: E.** The horn in F sounds a perfect 5th lower than written, so go DOWN a perfect 5th: B sounds as E.
6. **D: solo.** solo is Italian for "one player alone".
7. **D: with the wood of the bow.** col legno: tap or draw the string with the wood of the bow.
8. **D: mute.** sourdine is French for "mute".

Day 28: Compose from an opening: practice 1

Compose · about 40 minutes: warm-up 5 · teach 10 · together 10 · on his own 12 · game 3

1 · WARM-UP (5 MIN)

Today's practice in Philip's corner, or the first two 'together' questions below.

2 · TEACH (10 MIN)

Say: “Today is a real exam-style composition. Plan, write, check.”

- A full exam-style composition, timed: about 30 minutes.
- Use the checklist in the Compose game: length, phrases, cadences, modulation, climax, opening ideas reused, range, performance directions.

Worked example

The checklist.

1. 8 bars, bars add up.
2. Two phrases, cadence at bar 4.
3. Opening ideas reused; a clear modulation and return.
4. High point; ends on the tonic; in range; tempo, dynamics, phrasing, articulation.

Watch out for

- Starting to write without a plan.
- Running out of time for performance directions.

In the exam: About 35 minutes is a good time for question 3 in the real exam.

Show him these cards

1

Plan for 3 minutes: where are the cadences, the new key and the high point?

2

Write for about 25 minutes, then check with the checklist.

3

Get feedback: photograph it in the Compose game, or mark it yourself with the checklist.

3 · DO TOGETHER (10 MIN)

- Write it, then check it together with the checklist.

Four questions to work through together

1. What does this mean?

stringendo

- A. without a mute B. gradually getting faster C. majestically D. sustained

Answer: gradually getting faster. stringendo is Italian for "gradually getting faster".

2. Which German word means "the main part: bring it out"?

- A. ritmico B. non C. Hauptstimme D. sforzando (sf)

Answer: Hauptstimme. Hauptstimme is German for "the main part: bring it out".

3. Which German word means "lively"?

- A. ad libitum (ad lib.) B. giocoso C. lebhaft D. en dehors

Answer: lebhaft. lebhaft is German for "lively".

4. What does this mean?

lebhaft

- A. at the first speed B. one player alone C. suddenly D. lively

Answer: lively. lebhaft is German for "lively".

TODAY'S COMPOSITION OPENING

Continue this opening for cello to make a melody of 8 bars. It may modulate to the relative major (F major) or the dominant minor (A minor), then return to D minor. Add a tempo marking, dynamics, phrasing and other performance directions.



cello range: C2 upwards (tenor clef for high notes).

Plan it together

1. **Bars 1-2** are given. Notice the rhythm you'll reuse.
2. **Bars 3-4:** answer the opening (try its rhythm again, starting on a different note). End bar 4 on a long note of chord V (A, C#, E): an imperfect cadence.
3. **Bars 5-6:** move to F major. Use E, its leading note, and end bar 6 on F. Put your high point here.
4. **Bar 7:** bring back C#, the home key's leading note, and head back towards D.
5. **Bar 8:** D, the tonic, on the first beat, as a long note.
6. **Then add:** a tempo word, a dynamic at the start and one change, a crescendo to the high point, slurs over the phrases, and some articulation.

The checklist

1. 8 bars, and every bar adds up to the time signature
2. Two balanced phrases, with a clear cadence at bar 4
3. The opening's rhythm or shape comes back (repeat, sequence or a variation)
4. It modulates clearly (a new accidental, or in a minor key cancelling the raised 7th to reach the relative major) and comes back home
5. A clear high point, and a good shape: mostly steps with some leaps
6. It ends on the tonic, on a strong beat
7. It stays in the instrument's range and suits the instrument
8. A tempo marking (an Italian term is fine)
9. Dynamics, including at least one change
10. Phrasing slurs and some articulation (staccato, accents, tenuto)

MODEL ANSWER (SHOW IT AFTER HE HAS WRITTEN HIS OWN)

Andante espressivo



1. Bars 3–4 rise to C#, the leading note, held over chord V: an imperfect cadence.
2. Bars 5–6 fall by step to F on the downbeat of bar 6, with no C#: a cadence in F major, the relative major.
3. Bar 7 climbs to the high point (E4) and brings back C# to return to D minor.
4. Bar 8 ends on D, the tonic.
5. Performance directions: a tempo word (*Andante espressivo*), a quiet start, a crescendo to the high point, slurs over each phrase, and some staccato or accents where they suit the cello.

This is one good answer, not the only one. Compare yours: is the plan the same even if the notes are different?

4 • ON HIS OWN (12 MIN)

- Photograph it and ask for feedback in the Compose game.

His worksheet is on the next page (answers at the end).

5 • GAME (3 MIN)

Swap: you write a 2-bar opening; he continues it.

MOVE ON WHEN

He finishes in about 30 minutes and the checklist is all ticked.

Philip's worksheet · Day 28

Name _____ Date _____ Score ____ / 8

1. What does this mean?

cantabile

- A. bow over the fingerboard B. with the wood of the bow C. very D. in a singing style

2. What does this mean?

ottava (8va)

- A. nobly B. dying away in tone and speed C. expressively D. play an octave higher

3. What does this mean?

energico

- A. with energy B. gradually getting quieter C. but not too much D. with grief

4. What does this mean?

diminuendo (dim.)

- A. broadly B. gradually getting quieter C. loud D. pressing on, getting quicker

5. What does this mean?

a 2

- A. tenderly B. at the first speed C. with the wood of the bow D. both players play the same part

6. What does this mean?

pianissimo (pp)

- A. as before B. as fast as possible C. very quiet D. rhythmically

7. What does this mean?

vigoroso

- A. divided: the section splits onto separate notes B. vigorously C. with the wood of the bow D. moderately quiet

8. Which term means "noisily, boisterously"?

- A. maestoso B. a 2 C. non D. strepitoso

ANSWERS (FOR MUM)

1. **D: in a singing style.** cantabile is Italian for "in a singing style".
2. **D: play an octave higher.** ottava (8va) is Italian for "play an octave higher".
3. **A: with energy.** energico is Italian for "with energy".
4. **B: gradually getting quieter.** diminuendo (dim.) is Italian for "gradually getting quieter".
5. **D: both players play the same part.** a 2 is Italian for "both players play the same part".
6. **C: very quiet.** pianissimo (pp) is Italian for "very quiet".
7. **B: vigorously.** vigoroso is Italian for "vigorously".
8. **D: strepitoso.** strepitoso is Italian for "noisily, boisterously".

Day 29: Compose from an opening: practice 2

Compose · about 40 minutes: warm-up 5 · teach 10 · together 10 · on his own 12 · game 3

1 · WARM-UP (5 MIN)

Today's practice in Philip's corner, or the first two 'together' questions below.

2 · TEACH (10 MIN)

Say: "Minor keys need a little extra care with the 6th and 7th notes. Use the melodic minor going up if you need both."

- A second timed composition, for a different instrument and in a minor key.
- This time, plan for 3 minutes before writing: cadences, the new key and the climax.

Worked example

In A minor, the melody goes F-G[#]-A. Is that OK?

1. F to G[#] is an augmented 2nd.
2. Better: F[#]-G[#]-A (melodic minor going up) or E-G[#]-A.
3. Or avoid the 6th altogether: E-G[#]-A.

Watch out for

- Augmented 2nds in the melody.
- Forgetting to raise the leading note at the final cadence.

In the exam: Minor-key openings are common in question 3.

Show him these cards

1

A second timed composition: a different instrument, in a minor key.

2

In minor keys use the raised 7th near cadences, and avoid the augmented 2nd between notes 6 and 7.

3

The usual journey: to the relative major, then back home.

3 · DO TOGETHER (10 MIN)

- Write it and check it with the checklist.

Four questions to work through together

1. What does this mean?

alla marcia

- A. at a walking pace B. pompously, grandly C. coaxing, charmingly D. in the style of a march

Answer: in the style of a march. alla marcia is Italian for "in the style of a march".

2. What does this mean?

lento

- A. with tenderness B. with vigour, lively C. at a walking pace D. slow

Answer: slow. lento is Italian for "slow".

3. Which term means "in the same way"?

- A. amabile B. divisi (div.) C. simile D. lent et doux

Answer: simile. simile is Italian for "in the same way".

4. Which term means "very, much"?

- A. molto B. slentando C. risoluto D. tenuto

Answer: molto. molto is Italian for "very, much".

TODAY'S COMPOSITION OPENING

Continue this opening for violin to make a melody of 8 bars. It may modulate to the relative major (G major) or the dominant minor (B minor), then return to E minor. Add a tempo marking, dynamics, phrasing and other performance directions.



violin range: G3 upwards (comfortably up to about E6).

Plan it together

1. **Bars 1-2** are given. Notice the rhythm you'll reuse.
2. **Bars 3-4:** answer the opening (try its rhythm again, starting on a different note). End bar 4 on a long note of chord V (B, D#, F#): an imperfect cadence.
3. **Bars 5-6:** move to G major. Use F#, its leading note, and end bar 6 on G. Put your high point here.
4. **Bar 7:** bring back D#, the home key's leading note, and head back towards E.
5. **Bar 8:** E, the tonic, on the first beat, as a long note.
6. **Then add:** a tempo word, a dynamic at the start and one change, a crescendo to the high point, slurs over the phrases, and some articulation.

The checklist

1. 8 bars, and every bar adds up to the time signature
2. Two balanced phrases, with a clear cadence at bar 4
3. The opening's rhythm or shape comes back (repeat, sequence or a variation)
4. It modulates clearly (a new accidental, or in a minor key cancelling the raised 7th to reach the relative major) and comes back home
5. A clear high point, and a good shape: mostly steps with some leaps
6. It ends on the tonic, on a strong beat
7. It stays in the instrument's range and suits the instrument
8. A tempo marking (an Italian term is fine)
9. Dynamics, including at least one change
10. Phrasing slurs and some articulation (staccato, accents, tenuto)

MODEL ANSWER (SHOW IT AFTER HE HAS WRITTEN HIS OWN)

Moderato



1. Bars 3–4 repeat the opening idea and land on D#, the leading note, over chord V.
2. Bars 5–6 climb through an E minor arpeggio to the high point (D6, with D $\sharp$ instead of D#), then cadence in G major, the relative major.
3. Bar 7 brings back D# to return to E minor.
4. Bar 8: E, the tonic, for a whole bar.
5. Performance directions: a tempo word (*Moderato*), a quiet start, a crescendo to the high point, slurs over each phrase, and some staccato or accents where they suit the violin.

This is one good answer, not the only one. Compare yours: is the plan the same even if the notes are different?

4 • ON HIS OWN (12 MIN)

- Photograph it and ask for feedback in the Compose game.

His worksheet is on the next page (answers at the end).

5 • GAME (3 MIN)

Rhythm echo: clap the opening rhythm, then three variations of it.

MOVE ON WHEN

A complete melody with the checklist ticked, in a minor key.

Philip's worksheet · Day 29

Name _____ Date _____ Score ____ / 8

1. What does this mean?

larghetto

- A. rather slow (less slow than largo) B. passionately C. with the wood of the bow D. tearfully, sadly

2. Which term means "as if, almost"?

- A. alla marcia B. quasi C. mässig D. nobilmente

3. Which term means "as before"?

- A. come prima B. non C. doloroso D. attacca

4. What does this mean?

a niente

- A. lively, quick B. but not too much C. dying away to nothing D. at choice, freely

5. What does this mean?

breit

- A. furiously B. tearfully, sadly C. nobly D. broadly

6. Which term means "in the same way"?

- A. simile B. lent C. tempo primo D. rallentando (rall.)

7. Which term means "very quiet"?

- A. animé B. dal segno (D.S.) C. stretto D. pianissimo (pp)

8. What does this mean?

come prima

- A. as before B. with energy C. singing D. one player alone

ANSWERS (FOR MUM)

1. **A: rather slow (less slow than largo).** larghetto is Italian for "rather slow (less slow than largo)".
2. **B: quasi.** quasi is Italian for "as if, almost".
3. **A: come prima.** come prima is Italian for "as before".
4. **C: dying away to nothing.** a niente is Italian for "dying away to nothing".
5. **D: broadly.** breit is German for "broadly".
6. **A: simile.** simile is Italian for "in the same way".
7. **D: pianissimo (pp).** pianissimo (pp) is Italian for "very quiet".
8. **A: as before.** come prima is Italian for "as before".

Day 30: Musical terms and signs for Grade 6

Compose · about 40 minutes: warm-up 5 · teach 10 · together 10 · on his own 12 · game 3

1 · WARM-UP (5 MIN)

Today's practice in Philip's corner, or the first two 'together' questions below.

2 · TEACH (10 MIN)

Say: “Terms are quick marks in the exam. A few minutes of Word cards every day makes them stick.”

- Grade 6 scores use all the earlier terms plus more performance directions: string terms (pizz., arco, con sord., sul ponticello, col legno, div.), tempo and character words, and French and German terms.
- Ornaments may appear written out in the music.

Worked example

What's the difference between pizz. and col legno?

1. pizz.: pluck the string with a finger.
2. col legno: use the wood of the bow instead of the hair.
3. arco cancels pizz.: back to the bow.

Watch out for

- Confusing con sord. (with a mute) and senza sord. (without).
- Mixing up allargando (broadening) and accelerando.

In the exam: Expect several term questions in questions 4 and 5.

Show him these cards

1

String terms: pizz. (pluck), arco (bow), con sord. (with a mute), div. (divide), sul ponticello (near the bridge), col legno (with the wood of the bow).

2

Tempo and character: allargando, incalzando, calando, piacevole, nobilmente, and many more in your Word cards.

3

French and German appear too: en dehors (bring out), cédez (slow down), breit (broad), zart (tender).

3 · DO TOGETHER (10 MIN)

- Quiz each other on 20 terms.

Four questions to work through together

1. What does this mean?

rinforzando (rf, rfz)

- A. reinforcing, with a sudden accent B. singing C. sad D. playfully, jokingly

Answer: reinforcing, with a sudden accent. *rinforzando* (rf, rfz) is Italian for "reinforcing, with a sudden accent".

2. Which term means "gradually getting quieter"?

- A. stringendo B. decrescendo (decresc.) C. tristamente D. furioso

Answer: decrescendo (decresc.). *decrescendo* (decresc.) is Italian for "gradually getting quieter".

3. What does this mean?

zart

- A. pressing on, getting quicker B. lovable, pleasant C. tenderly, delicately D. moderately loud

Answer: tenderly, delicately. *zart* is German for "tenderly, delicately".

4. Which term means "press the soft pedal"?

- A. una corda B. affettuoso C. poco D. scherzando

Answer: una corda. *una corda* is Italian for "press the soft pedal".

TODAY'S COMPOSITION OPENING

Continue this opening for flute to make a melody of 8 bars. It should modulate to the dominant (F major), then return to B $\flat$ major. Add a tempo marking, dynamics, phrasing and other performance directions.



flute range: C4 to about C7.

Plan it together

1. **Bars 1-2** are given. Notice the rhythm you'll reuse.
2. **Bars 3-4:** answer the opening (try its rhythm again, starting on a different note). End bar 4 on a long note of chord V (F, A, C): an imperfect cadence.
3. **Bars 5-6:** move to F major. Use E, its leading note, and end bar 6 on F. Put your high point here.
4. **Bar 7:** cancel E with E $\flat$, and head back towards B $\flat$.
5. **Bar 8:** B $\flat$, the tonic, on the first beat, as a long note.
6. **Then add:** a tempo word, a dynamic at the start and one change, a crescendo to the high point, slurs over the phrases, and some articulation.

The checklist

1. 8 bars, and every bar adds up to the time signature
2. Two balanced phrases, with a clear cadence at bar 4
3. The opening's rhythm or shape comes back (repeat, sequence or a variation)
4. It modulates clearly (a new accidental, or in a minor key cancelling the raised 7th to reach the relative major) and comes back home
5. A clear high point, and a good shape: mostly steps with some leaps
6. It ends on the tonic, on a strong beat
7. It stays in the instrument's range and suits the instrument
8. A tempo marking (an Italian term is fine)
9. Dynamics, including at least one change
10. Phrasing slurs and some articulation (staccato, accents, tenuto)

MODEL ANSWER (SHOW IT AFTER HE HAS WRITTEN HIS OWN)

Allegro moderato



1. Bar 3 is a sequence of bar 1, a step higher; bar 4 holds F, the dominant.
2. Bar 5 climbs to the high B $\flat$ and uses E $\sharp$, the leading note of F major, so bar 6 cadences in the dominant.
3. Bar 7 brings back E $\flat$ and steps down home.
4. Bar 8: B $\flat$, the tonic.
5. Performance directions: a tempo word (*Allegro moderato*), a quiet start, a crescendo to the high point, slurs over each phrase, and some staccato or accents where they suit the flute.

This is one good answer, not the only one. Compare yours: is the plan the same even if the notes are different?

4 • ON HIS OWN (12 MIN)

- Musical terms and Word cards in Philip's corner.

His worksheet is on the next page (answers at the end).

5 • GAME (3 MIN)

Charades: act out a term; the other person names it.

MOVE ON WHEN

He knows all the terms in the Word cards.

Philip's worksheet · Day 30

Name _____ Date _____ Score ____ / 8

1. What does this mean?

piacevole

- A. held B. too much C. pleasantly D. at the first speed

2. What does this mean?

fine

- A. tearfully, sadly B. rather slow (less slow than largo) C. getting faster (pressing on) D. the end

3. Which term means "coaxing, charmingly"?

- A. con brio B. lusingando C. smorzando (smorz.) D. giocoso

4. Which term means "together again: all play the same notes"?

- A. unisono (unis.) B. poco C. sul ponticello D. forte (f)

5. Which French word means "slow and soft"?

- A. ad libitum (ad lib.) B. legato C. lent et doux D. allegro

6. Which term means "at a walking pace"?

- A. schnell B. nicht schleppen C. andante D. ruhig

7. Which term means "lively, quick"?

- A. en dehors B. zart C. nobilmente D. vivo

8. What does this mean?

espressivo

- A. lively B. plucked C. expressively D. nobly

ANSWERS (FOR MUM)

1. **C: pleasantly.** piacevole is Italian for "pleasantly".
2. **D: the end.** fine is Italian for "the end".
3. **B: lusingando.** lusingando is Italian for "coaxing, charmingly".
4. **A: unisono (unis.)** unisono (unis.) is Italian for "together again: all play the same notes".
5. **C: lent et doux.** lent et doux is French for "slow and soft".
6. **C: andante.** andante is Italian for "at a walking pace".
7. **D: vivo.** vivo is Italian for "lively, quick".
8. **C: expressively.** espressivo is Italian for "expressively".

Day 31: Review: composition (Days 25-30)

Compose · about 40 minutes: warm-up 5 · teach 10 · together 10 · on his own 12 · game 3

1 · WARM-UP (5 MIN)

Today's practice in Philip's corner, or the first two 'together' questions below.

2 · TEACH (10 MIN)

- Go back over Days 25-30. Write one more melody from an opening, with full performance directions.

Show him these cards

1

Eight bars: two 4-bar phrases.
Phrase 1 ends with an imperfect cadence (or a new key). Phrase 2 answers and ends on the tonic.

2

Plan: bars 1-4 in the home key, bars 5-6 in the new key (with its new accidental), bars 7-8 back home with a perfect cadence.

3

Know the instrument: violin from G3 up; flute from C4 up; oboe from B $\flat$ 3; cello from C2 (in bass clef).

4

Plan for 3 minutes: where are the cadences, the new key and the high point?

5

A second timed composition: a different instrument, in a minor key.

6

String terms: pizz. (pluck), arco (bow), con sord. (with a mute), div. (divide), sul ponticello (near the bridge), col legno (with the wood of the bow).

3 · DO TOGETHER (10 MIN)

- Mark it together with the checklist.

Four questions to work through together

1. Which term means "gradually getting faster"?

A. nicht schleppen B. accelerando (accel.) C. da capo (D.C.) D. maestoso

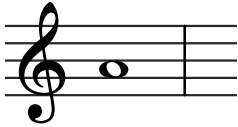
Answer: accelerando (accel.). accelerando (accel.) is Italian for "gradually getting faster".

2. Which key is NOT closely related to F $\sharp$ minor?

A. A major B. D major C. A minor D. B minor

Answer: A minor. The closely related keys of F $\sharp$ minor are A major, C $\sharp$ minor, B minor, E major, D major: the relative, dominant and subdominant, and their relatives.

3. This is the sound you want from the cor anglais. Which note must be written for it?



A. E $\flat$

B. A

C. D

D. E

Answer: E. The cor anglais sounds a perfect 5th lower than written, so write it UP a perfect 5th: A is written as E.

4. Which term means "as if, almost"?

A. solo

B. quasi

C. appassionato

D. lacrimoso

Answer: quasi. quasi is Italian for "as if, almost".

TODAY'S COMPOSITION OPENING

Continue this opening for cello to make a melody of 8 bars. It should modulate to the dominant (D major), then return to G major. Add a tempo marking, dynamics, phrasing and other performance directions.



cello range: C2 upwards (tenor clef for high notes).

Plan it together

1. **Bars 1-2** are given. Notice the rhythm you'll reuse.
2. **Bars 3-4:** answer the opening (try its rhythm again, starting on a different note). End bar 4 on a long note of chord V (D, F#, A): an imperfect cadence.
3. **Bars 5-6:** move to D major. Use C#, its leading note, and end bar 6 on D. Put your high point here.
4. **Bar 7:** cancel C# with C, and head back towards G.
5. **Bar 8:** G, the tonic, on the first beat, as a long note.
6. **Then add:** a tempo word, a dynamic at the start and one change, a crescendo to the high point, slurs over the phrases, and some articulation.

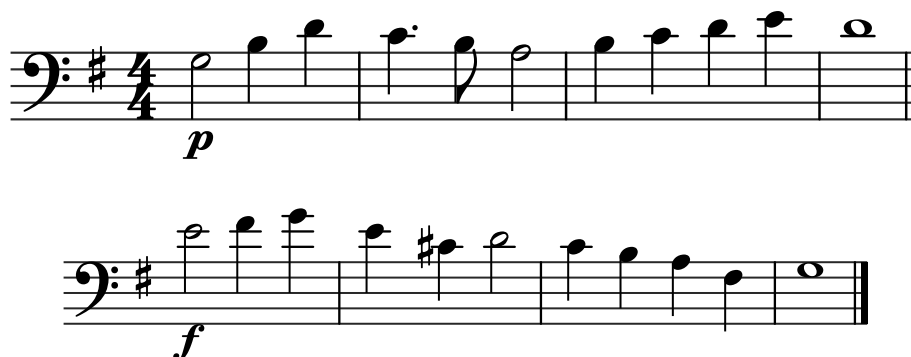
The checklist

1. 8 bars, and every bar adds up to the time signature
2. Two balanced phrases, with a clear cadence at bar 4
3. The opening's rhythm or shape comes back (repeat, sequence or a variation)
4. It modulates clearly (a new accidental, or in a minor key cancelling the raised 7th to reach the relative major) and comes back home
5. A clear high point, and a good shape: mostly steps with some leaps

6. It ends on the tonic, on a strong beat
7. It stays in the instrument's range and suits the instrument
8. A tempo marking (an Italian term is fine)
9. Dynamics, including at least one change
10. Phrasing slurs and some articulation (staccato, accents, tenuto)

MODEL ANSWER (SHOW IT AFTER HE HAS WRITTEN HIS OWN)

Andante



1. Bars 3–4 climb by step to D, the dominant, held for a bar.
2. Bars 5–6 reach the high point (G4) and use C#: a cadence in D major, the dominant.
3. Bar 7 brings back C $\sharp$ and walks down to the leading note F $\sharp$.
4. Bar 8: G, the tonic.
5. Performance directions: a tempo word (*Andante*), a quiet start, a crescendo to the high point, slurs over each phrase, and some staccato or accents where they suit the cello.

This is one good answer, not the only one. Compare yours: is the plan the same even if the notes are different?

4 • ON HIS OWN (12 MIN)

- Today's practice.

His worksheet is on the next page (answers at the end).

5 • GAME (3 MIN)

Match pairs: terms.

MOVE ON WHEN

A strong melody he's proud of.

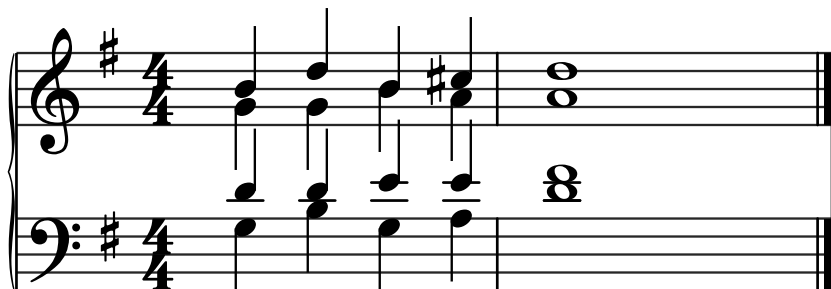
Philip's worksheet · Day 31

Name _____ Date _____ Score ____ / 8

1. Which term means "rhythmically"?

- A. ritmico B. lent et doux C. tre corde D. largo

2. This passage starts in G major. Which key does it end in?



- A. G major B. D major C. E minor D. C major

3. In a full orchestral score, which of these is written lower down the page?

- A. horn B. oboe

4. Which term means "in strict time"?

- A. subito B. unisono (unis.) C. ritmico D. tempo giusto

5. Which key is NOT closely related to A $\flat$ major?

- A. E $\flat$ major B. D $\flat$ major C. F minor D. E major

6. What does 'col legno' mean?

- A. with a mute B. very smoothly C. with the wood of the bow D. near the bridge

7. Which term means "repeat from the beginning and stop at Fine"?

- A. tempo giusto B. lebhaft C. cantando D. da capo al fine

8. What is the relative major of E minor?

- A. A $\flat$ major B. G minor C. B $\flat$ minor D. G major

ANSWERS (FOR MUM)

1. **A: ritmico.** ritmico is Italian for "rhythmically".
2. **B: D major.** It ends with a perfect cadence in D major: A-C#-E then D-F#-A. Look for the new accidental: C# is the new key's leading note.
3. **A: horn.** Score order from the top: woodwind (flute, oboe, clarinet, bassoon), brass (horn, trumpet, trombone, tuba), percussion (timpani first), then strings (violin I, violin II, viola, cello, double bass). So oboe comes above horn.
4. **D: tempo giusto.** tempo giusto is Italian for "in strict time".
5. **D: E major.** The closely related keys of A $\flat$ major are F minor, E $\flat$ major, D $\flat$ major, C minor, B $\flat$ minor: the relative, dominant and subdominant, and their relatives.
6. **C: with the wood of the bow.** col legno: tap or draw the string with the wood of the bow.
7. **D: da capo al fine.** da capo al fine is Italian for "repeat from the beginning and stop at Fine".
8. **D: G major.** Relative keys share a key signature: E minor and G major.